



# INDIVIDUAL REPORT

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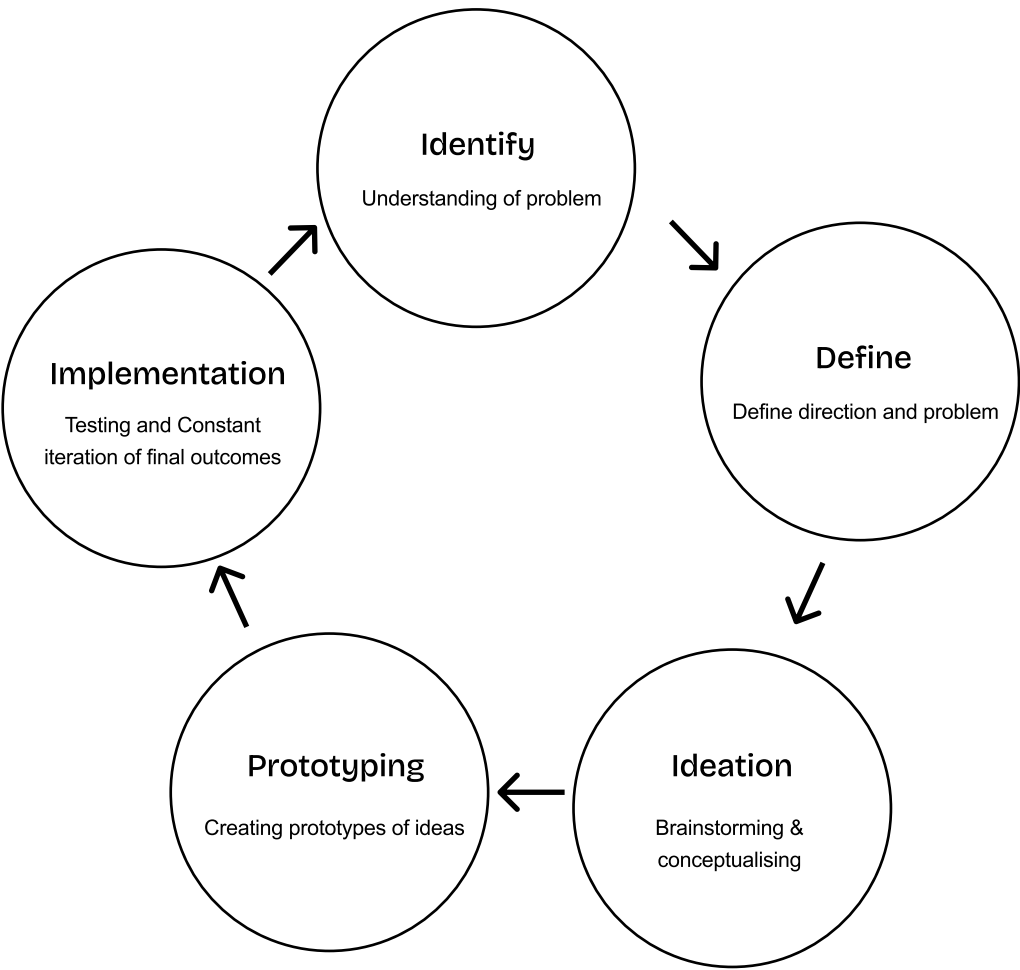
## Designer profile

## Team Lead | Interactive Designer

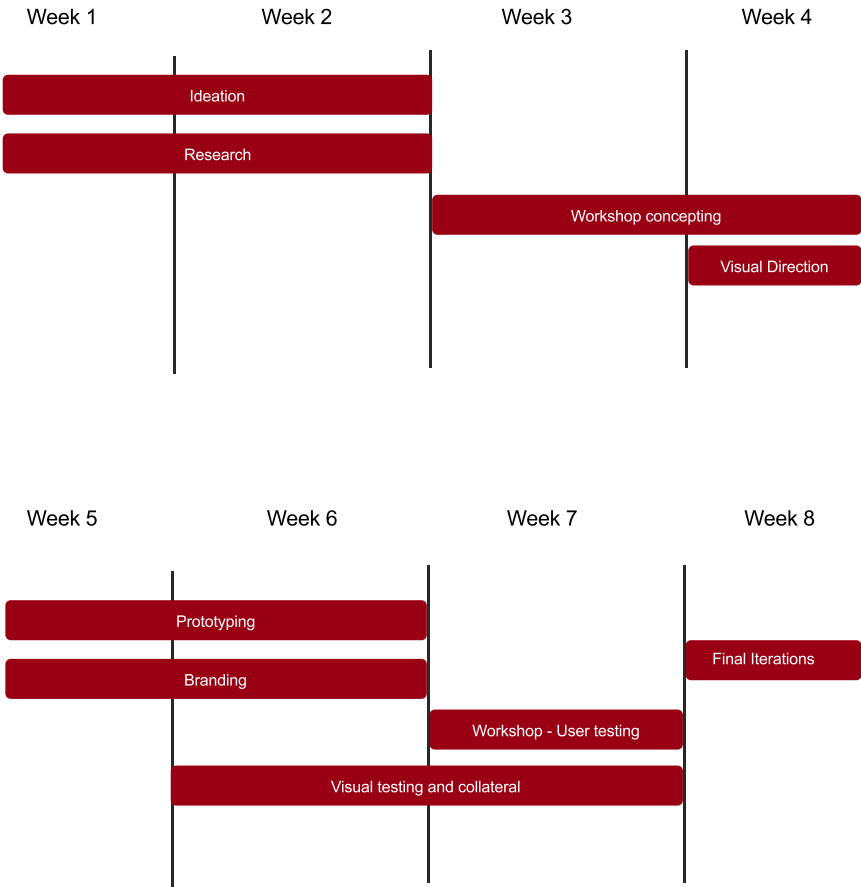
As Team Leader, I managed production timelines, delegated tasks, and kept the team aligned toward cohesive outputs. In my role as Interactive designer, I identified core problems and conceptualised solutions across installations, tangible experiences, and visual direction to ensure a meaningful, unified result.

# METHODOLOGY

The Reflexive methodology was used for this project, discussing assumptions, motivations and constant debrief with team members, reflecting at each stage.



# TIMELINE



## OUR BRIEF

“How might digital media communicate the regeneration of Te Ara Tukutuku to help people maintain or increase their connection with this place — tāngata, whenua and moana?”

## PROBLEM STATEMENT

“People new to Te Ara Tukutuku currently walk past without recognising the regeneration underway, misreading a living act of healing as a construction site. As a result, the formative phase, the rare window in which a lasting connection to this place could be formed, passes without that connection ever taking root.”

## INITIAL RESEARCH

For research, we looked at Mana Moana, an immersive multimedia experience on Auckland's waterfront. It brought together over 20 Māori and Pasifika artists from across Aotearoa, combining art and technology through video art, VR, and 3D digital sculpture. The exhibition explored our relationship with water and the importance of protecting it for future generations.



From the client brief presentation, the 'walking backwards into the future' analogy stuck with me, as we felt this would be the perfect concept to follow for our outcome for Auckland Urban Development.

Educate vs. evoke. Mana Moana isn't really educating people about Pacific cosmology in the way a museum panel does. It's putting people inside an emotional and sensory register where the kaupapa can be felt. The information is there, but it's downstream of the atmosphere. If your project leans too hard on "tell them the history and future," you can end up with a beautifully styled timeline — which is still fundamentally an informational website, just with better art direction. The braver move, and the one closer to what makes Mana Moana work, is asking: what does it feel like to walk backwards into the future on this specific piece of whenua? What's the wairua of a place that was moana, became industrial, became contaminated, and is now being healed?

What does it feel like to walk backwards into the future on this specific piece of whenua?

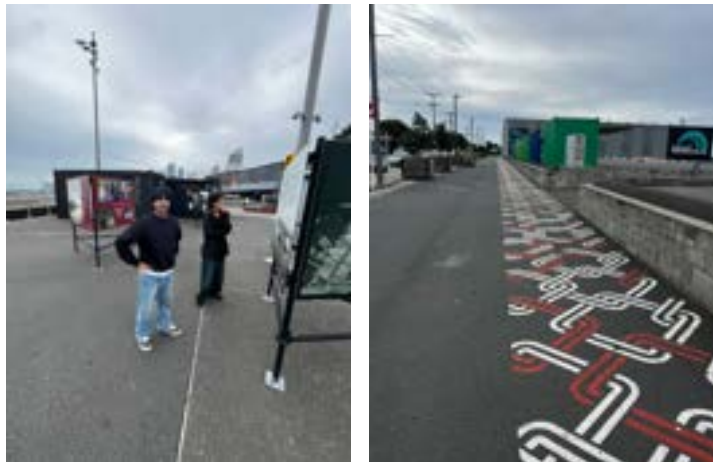
Jarrah

What's the wairua of the place that was moana, became industrial, became contaminated, and is now being healed?

Jarrah

# FIELD REVIEW

To get a first-hand understanding of the communication issue and environmental feel, we visited Te Ara Tukutuku. After visiting the site, we noticed that there was little information on site about the regeneration that was easily detectable. The information was on a poster and was text-heavy and difficult to read, which was not easily digestible.



After visiting the site, we took notes and summarised the key insights and action points to move on to the ideation phase.

## Key insights:

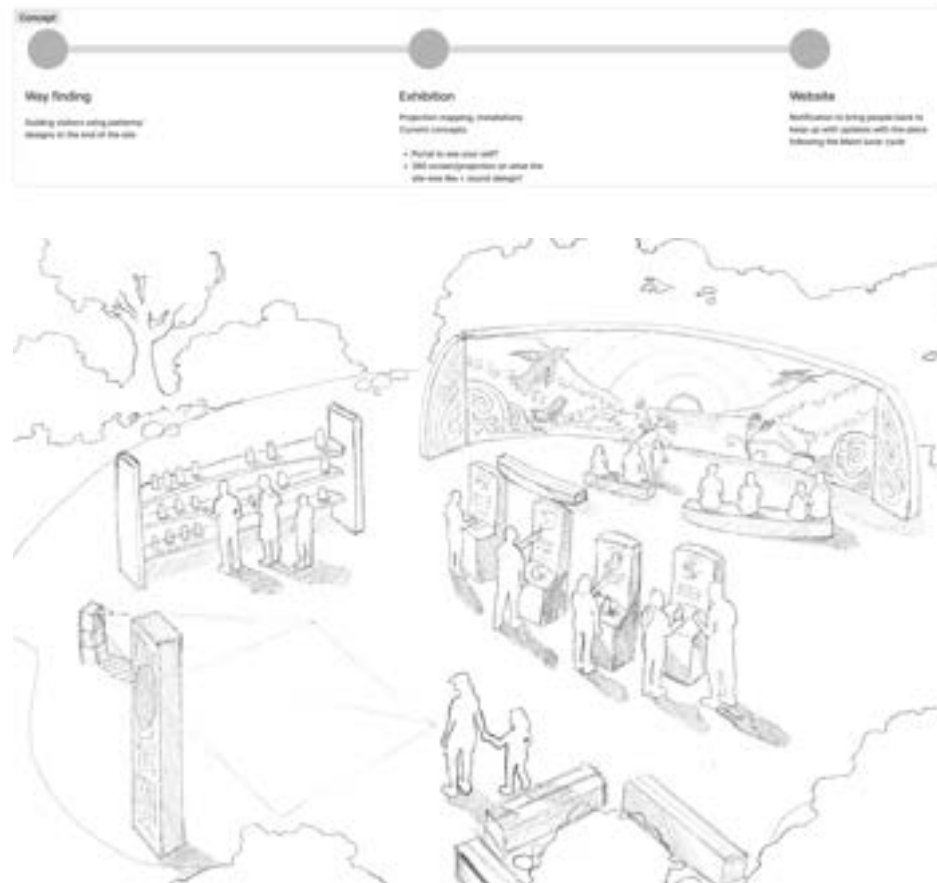


## Core focus areas:



# IDEATION

The initial idea we pitched to the client was a digital garden, where visitors could place a physical figure of a native bird or plant found on site onto a kiosk, give it a name, and then see it live on a digital screen on site, creating a personal, memorable experience. The client didn't agree with the idea, so we continued ideating

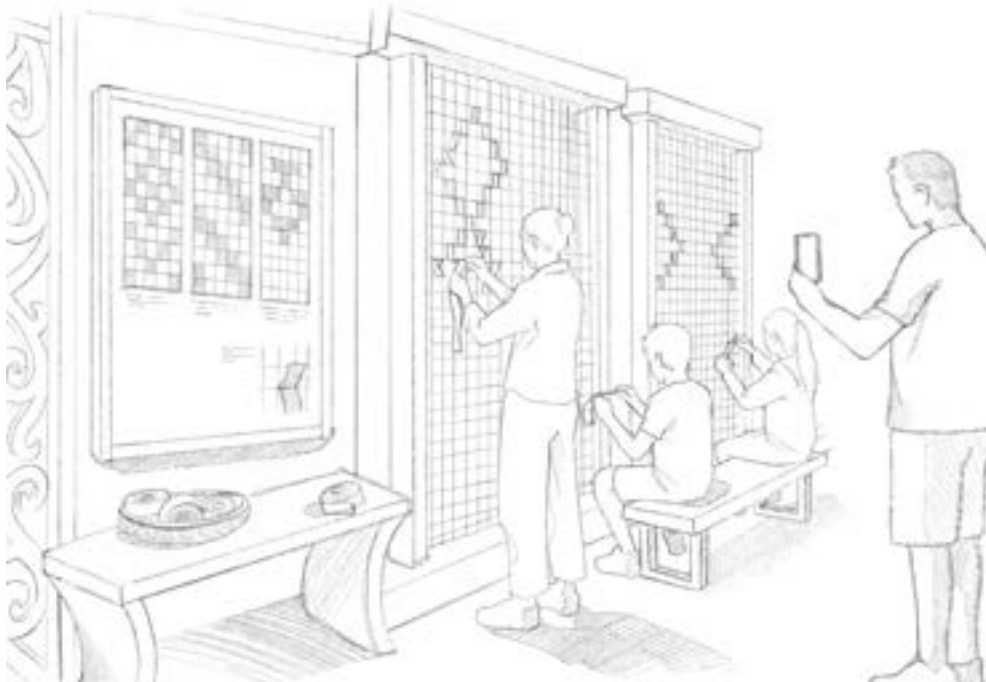


My initial moodboard explored weaving as a concept. We looked at contemporary design, as we wanted to stay away from the typical, expected green, blue, and white.



## IDEATION

After the pivot in direction, we looked into the concept of weaving, as the name 'Te Ara Tukutuku' refers to weaving. Playing on that idea, we felt the concept of weaving people together was a strong one.



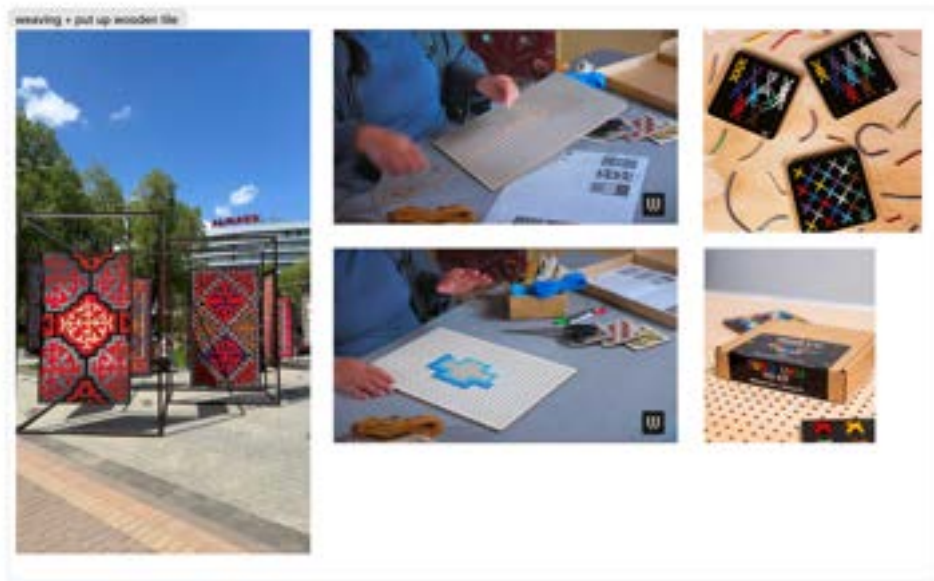
Due to the culturally diverse demographic of Auckland, we explored the idea of weaving people from different cultures together. Through research, we found that many patterns overlap across different cultures.



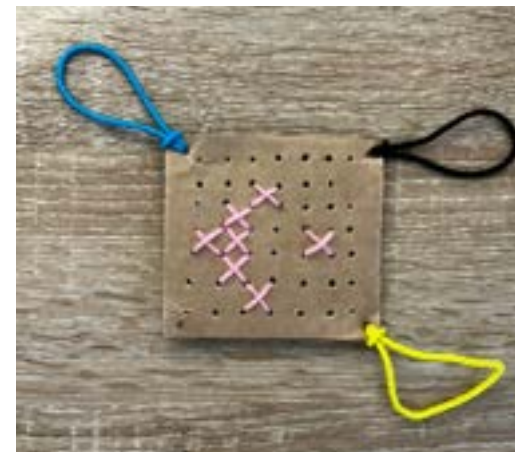
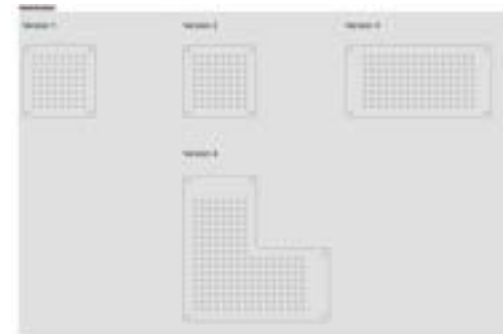
# PROTOTYPING

We looked at the idea of weaving your own tile and then putting it up to becoming a permanent part of Te Ara Tukutuku.

We did developed a physical prototype of the wooden tile and grid.

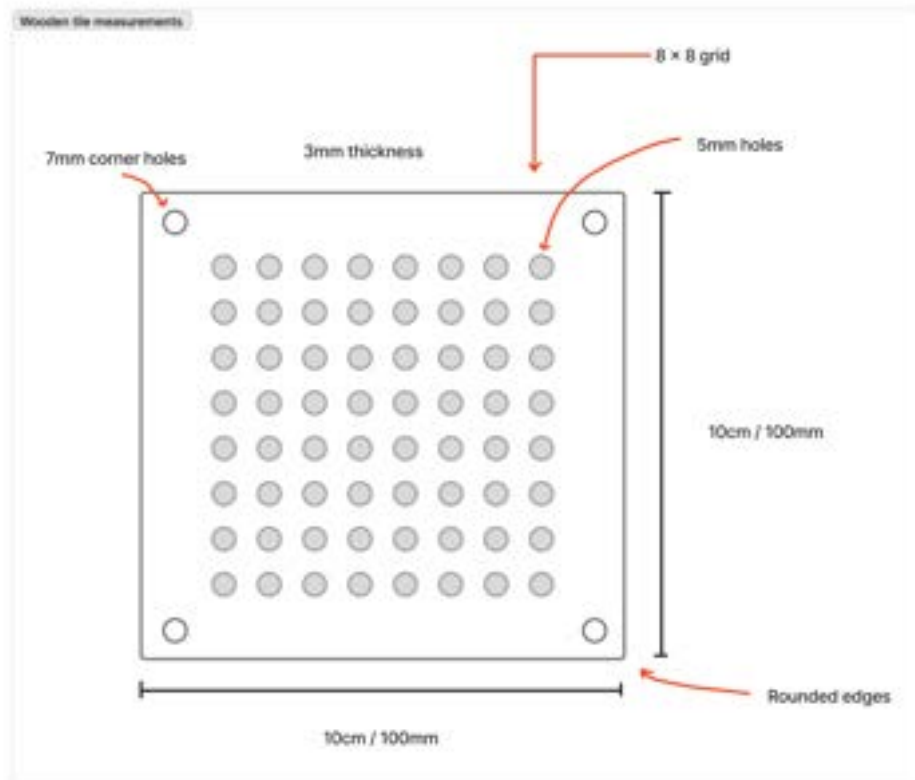


We mocked up different shapes and sizes for the wooden tile in Figma and created a physical prototype to test the look and feel of it.



## WOODEN TILE

We sent a detailed sketch and requirements off to a laser-cutting service to get a test piece cut.



Then we had one test piece laser-cut for us by 'MAKE SHOP' on K' Road. We tested weaving with regular yarn and string, and found it perfect for the weaving experience.

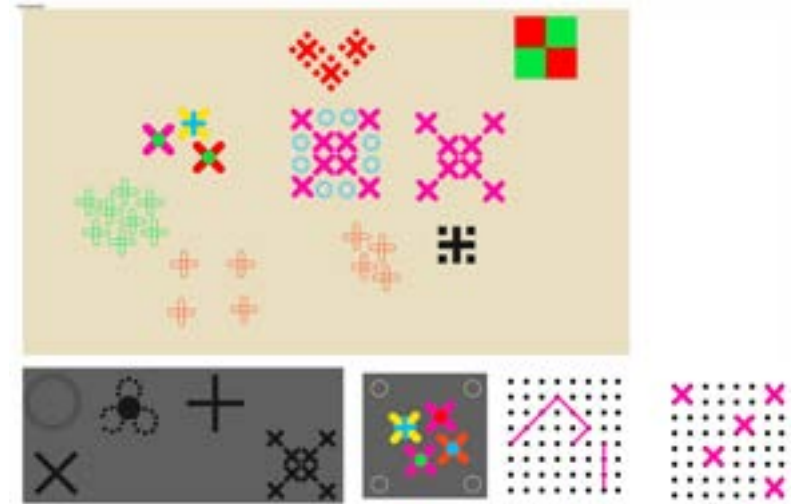


## VISUAL DIRECTION

As previously mentioned, we wanted the theme to be 'weaving people from different cultures together'. For this, we looked at contemporary, bold visuals that we felt would best suit the desired communication.



The visual direction started with testing various patterns and different colour combinations to see what works best.

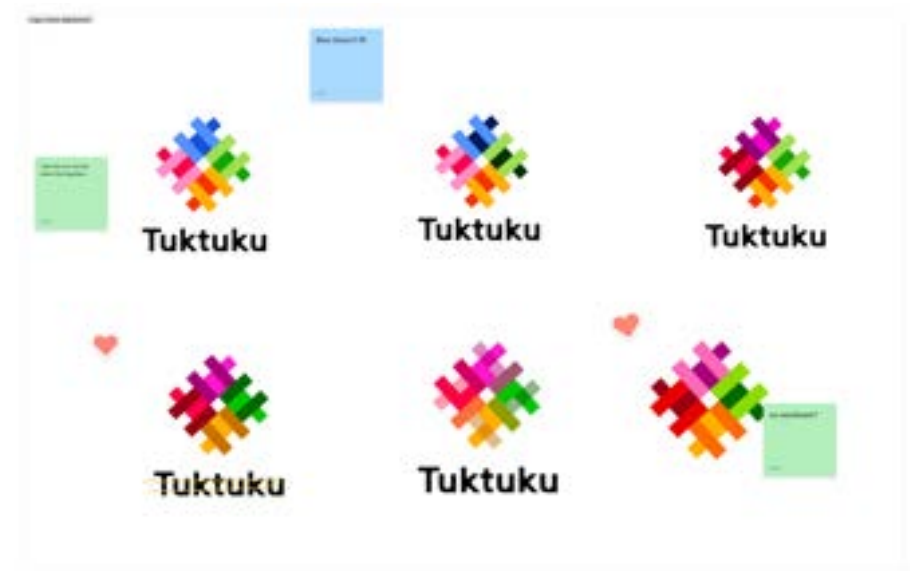


## VISUAL DIRECTION

After multiple refinements, we found a good combination of colours and tested various layouts and typefaces to see what worked best.



"After multiple feedback rounds from mentors and fellow colleagues, we found that the logo's colour combination was off, so we adjusted the colour combination and typefaces for the logo.



## MATERIAL AND GRIDWALL

Once the visual direction was finalised, we purchased yarn in cohesive colours that worked well together, and tested it on site at the shopping centre to make sure everything worked as expected.

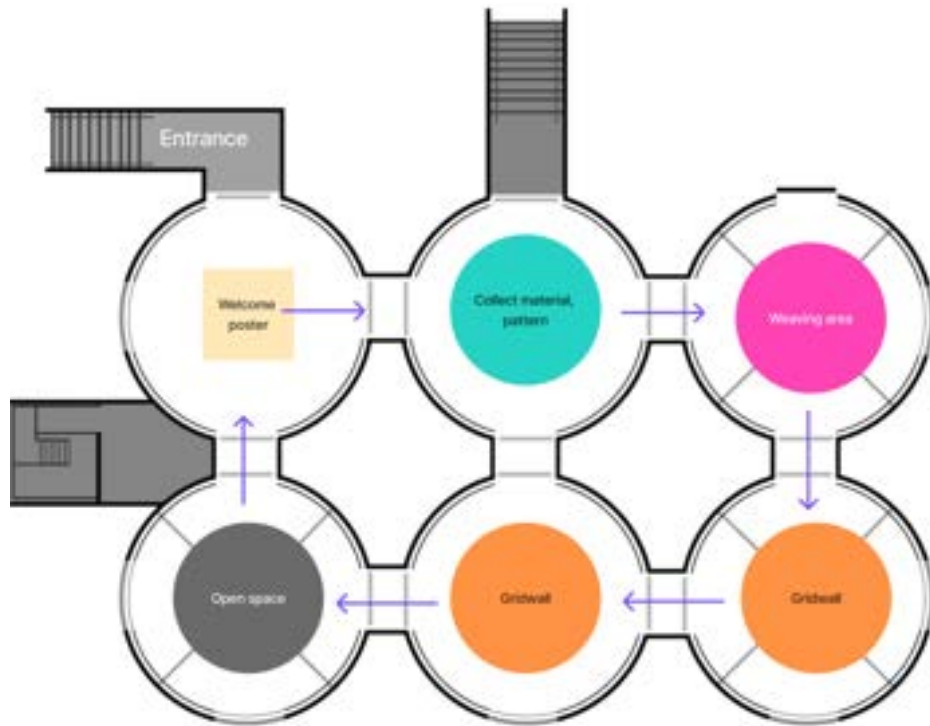


For the grid wall, we purchased the most affordable and feasible grid wall we could find, to allow people to put up their Tukutuku wooden tile.

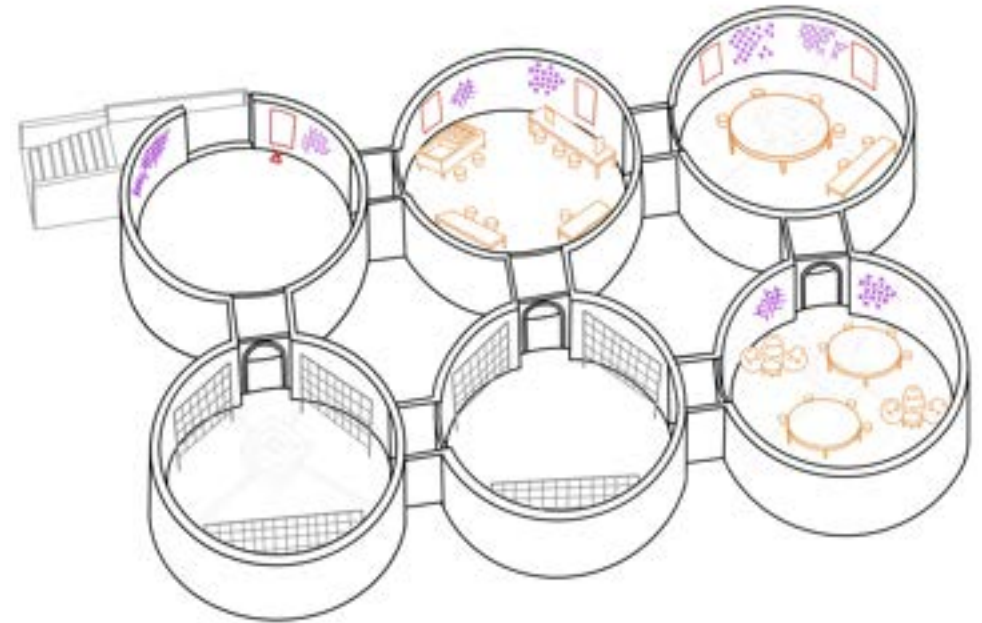


## SPATIAL DESIGN

We chose Silo 6 as the optimal place for our weaving workshop, as it was close to Te Ara Tukumuku and a popular spot amongst Aucklanders for events like these. We mapped out a spatial design sketch that matched the desired user flow for the experience.



To get a better idea of the spatial design and layout, we sketched a detailed spatial mock-up for clients to understand.

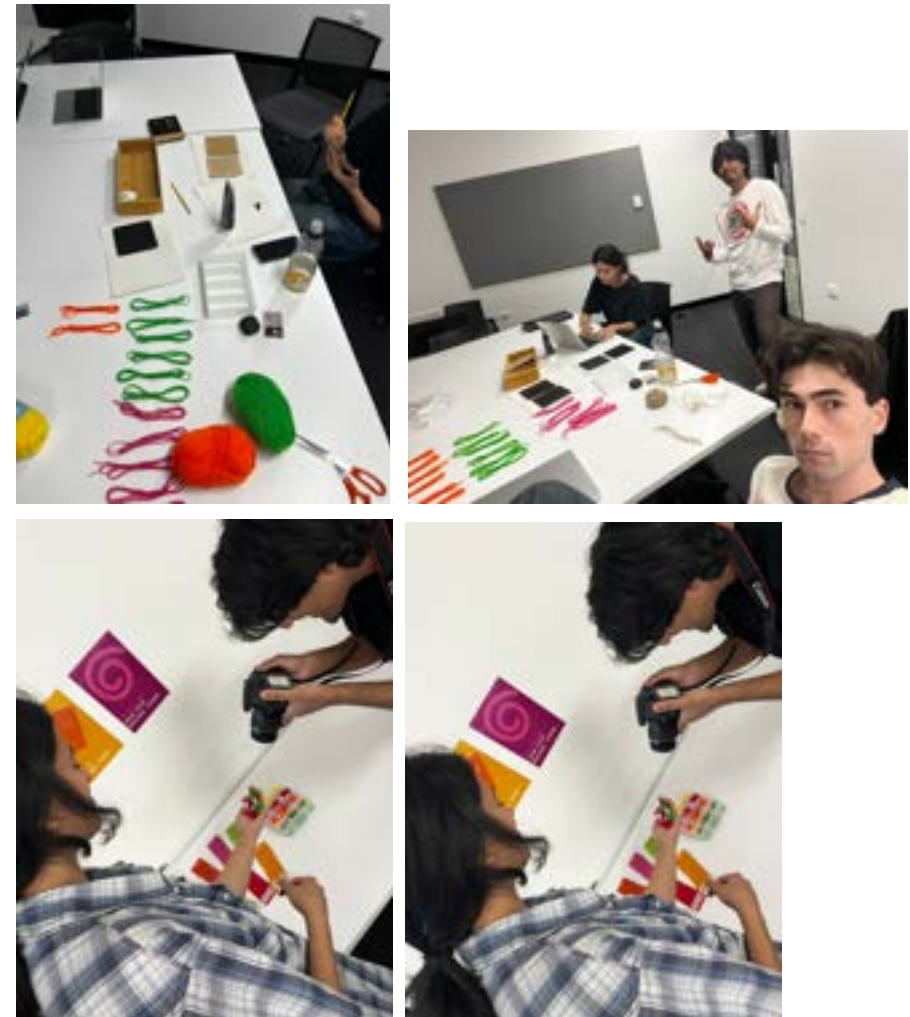


## WORKSHOP - USER TESTING

We hosted a user testing weaving session on campus to get feedback and insights on the experience.



"The setup of the workshop started by reserving a room and organising the space, followed by preparing the weaving materials and delegating tasks for photography, weaving assistance, and user interviews.



## WORKSHOP - USER TESTING

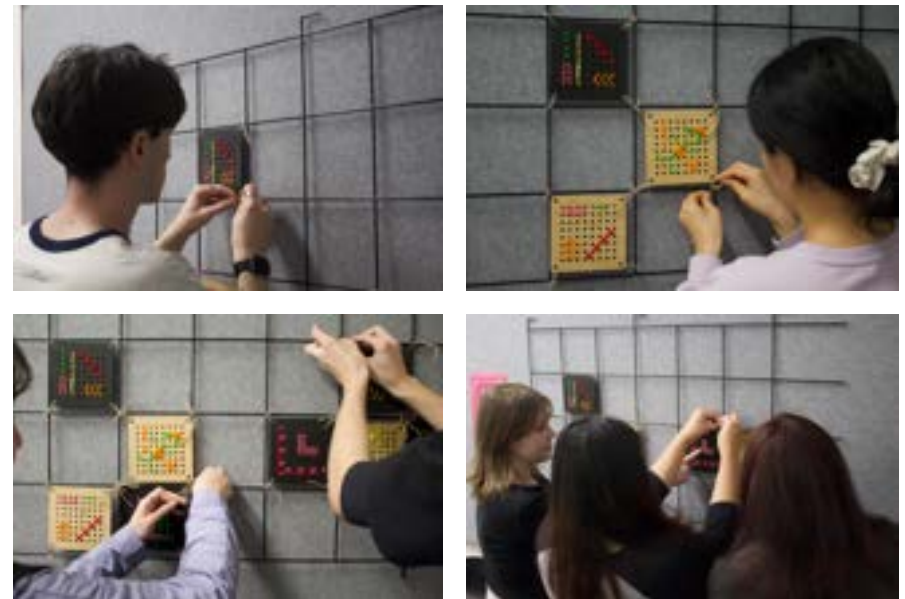
We ended up getting great photos of the experience valuable feedback and insights on the experience.



We collected key insights, refined the user flow, and removed some parts of the experience, then presented these findings in the final presentation to answer some of the client's questions from previous WIPs regarding the experience.



'User interviews'



## THE FUTURE

We received great feedback from the clients in the final presentation. There were a couple of parts missing from the experience that could have taken it from good to even better. We hope to refine this project further in the future, as there was interest from both the clients and the people who participated in the user testing session.

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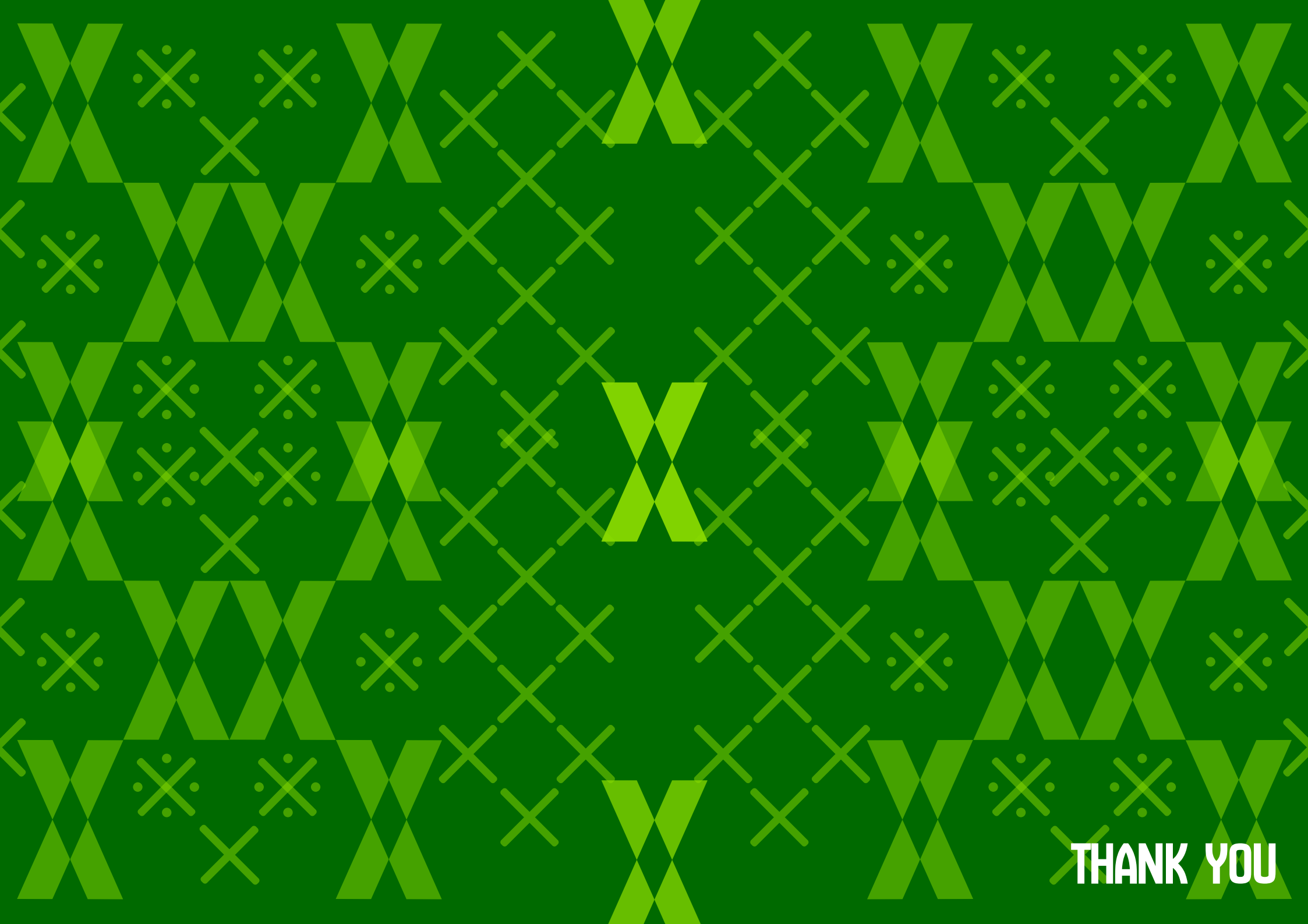
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**THANK YOU**

